Ohio Revenue Audit Bureau (fictional agency)

Sales and Use Tax Audit Division

Notice of Audit Findings and Proposed Assessment

Field	Detail
Notice date	September 15, 2026
Case number	OH-SUT-2026-04417
Taxpayer	Meridian Financial Group, Inc.
Audit period	January 1, 2026 through June 30, 2026
Tax type	Ohio sales and use tax
Response due	November 16, 2026

Findings

The Bureau examined a sample of purchase invoices delivered to Ohio locations during the audit period on which no sales tax was charged on the basis of an exemption. For the invoices listed below, the taxpayer did not hold a valid exemption certificate on the invoice date. The Bureau therefore proposes to assess use tax at the state rate of 5.75% on the full invoice amount.

Invoice	Invoice date	Vendor	Invoice amount	Certificate	Finding	Tax at 5.75%
INV-2026-0901	2026-02-11	Delta Tower Components	$86,450.00	EC-0008	Certificate expired 2024-03-14	$4,970.88
INV-2026-0902	2026-03-04	Keystone Cabling Co	$124,980.00	EC-0014	Certificate expired 2025-01-09	$7,186.35
INV-2026-0903	2026-04-22	Delta Tower Components	$57,310.50	EC-0008	Certificate expired 2024-03-14	$3,295.35
INV-2026-0904	2026-05-19	Ironwood Radio Equipment	$73,200.00	none on file	No certificate provided	$4,209.00
					Total tax	$19,661.58

Proposed assessment

Component	Amount
Use tax on sampled invoices	$19,661.58
Penalty (10% of tax)	$1,966.16
Total proposed assessment, before interest	$21,627.74

Interest accrues from the original due date of each return until paid and will be computed on the final assessment.

Projection to the full audit period

The invoices above were selected by sample. If the taxpayer cannot show that the error is limited to the sampled invoices, the Bureau may project the error rate across all exempt purchases delivered to Ohio during the audit period. The taxpayer is invited to review the full population and voluntarily disclose any additional invoices with the same deficiency; voluntary disclosure before the response date will not attract the 10% penalty.

How to respond

1. Submit any valid exemption certificate that was in effect on the invoice date for each listed invoice.
2. Submit a schedule of any additional exempt Ohio invoices in the audit period lacking a valid certificate.
3. Pay the agreed amount or file a written objection by November 16, 2026, quoting case OH-SUT-2026-04417.

Certificates obtained after the date of this notice will not be accepted for invoices dated before this notice.

Auditor of record: R. Delacroix, Senior Tax Auditor (fictional)